General Emergence Mechanics from A to Z

An Overview of the Core Framework, Exploratory Extensions, Simulations, and Companion Papers

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May 2026

Abstract

This paper provides an overview of General Emergence Mechanics (GEM) as an emerging cross-domain research programme. GEM begins from a simple claim: stable structures persist only when they remain coherent within a dynamical shell governed by depth, stiffness, and viscosity or relaxation time. From this starting point, GEM has been explored across a widening set of domains including materials, computational systems, gravity, evolution, biology, traffic control, and the possible emergence of fundamental constants. The purpose of the present note is not to introduce a new branch of the framework, but to map the programme as a whole. It summarises the central concepts, clarifies the current maturity of the different branches, and provides a consolidated guide to the companion papers and simulations published so far. The paper is intended both as an entry point for new readers and as a programme-level summary of the current state of GEM.

Keywords: General Emergence Mechanics, GEM, persistence mechanics, coherence shell, overview, research programme, emergence, stability, resilience, cross-domain framework

Note. This paper is an overview and synthesis note. It surveys the current GEM programme and its companion papers rather than presenting a new derivation or simulation result of its own.

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1 Introduction

General Emergence Mechanics (GEM) is a framework built around a simple but far-reaching question: what allows structures to remain coherent under stress, disturbance, or change? Instead of beginning from substance, object, or geometry alone, GEM begins from persistence. A structure exists, in the meaningful sense, only if it can remain sufficiently coherent to resist collapse and recover from perturbation.

The framework emerged from an effort to describe stable existence in terms of a dynamical coherence shell rather than a static background. In its current form, GEM is organised around three coupled axes:

- **depth**, representing resilience or the barrier to collapse,
- **stiffness**, representing immediate resistance to distortion,
- **viscosity or relaxation time**, representing the speed or slowness of recovery.

These axes combine to determine whether a system remains above a persistence threshold or falls into degradation, drift, metastability, or collapse.

GEM did not emerge in isolation. Some of its earlier conceptual roots lie in the broader MT/GCF line of thought, especially in relation to vacuum structure, preferred phase organisation, and shell-like persistence ideas. However, the present overview treats GEM as a distinct framework in its own right: one that has now developed its own language, its own research branches, and its own companion literature.

The aim of this paper is to provide a map of that literature and of the framework it supports.

2 The Core Idea of GEM

At the centre of GEM is the claim that persistent systems are not merely those that happen to last for some time, but those that maintain coherence inside a dynamical shell. This shell is not necessarily a physical membrane; it is a structured persistence domain within which disturbances can be absorbed, resisted, and dissipated without total loss of identity.

At the most schematic level, one may write a persistence functional

$$P = P(D, \kappa, \tau, \ldots),$$

where:

- D is effective depth,
- κ is effective stiffness,
- τ is effective viscosity or relaxation time.

A system remains viable when

$$P > P_{\min},$$

and becomes fragile, distorted, or unstable when the persistence score falls below threshold.

This provides a common language for very different systems. A material, a biological organism, a traffic network, a computational process, or a speculative gravitational shell may all be discussed in terms of:

- how much disturbance they can absorb,
- how strongly they resist deformation,
- how quickly they recover when perturbed.

The attraction of GEM is precisely that the same structural grammar appears repeatedly across many domains.

3 Why GEM is Cross-Domain

A useful framework does not have to explain everything equally well, but it should travel. GEM travels because many systems share the same persistence logic even when their detailed physical content differs.

Across domains, similar patterns recur:

- threshold behaviour,
- abrupt collapse,
- metastability,
- hysteresis,
- slow recovery,
- cascading failure,
- resilience under repeated stress.

GEM does not begin by assuming that a material, organism, theory of gravity, or social system are fundamentally the same thing. Rather, it suggests that they may share a common *persistence architecture*. That is why the framework can be extended from one domain to another without merely becoming metaphor.

4 The Current GEM Research Constellation

The GEM programme has now developed into a family of connected papers rather than a single manuscript. Some papers introduce the core framework; others explore domain-specific applications; others provide toy simulations or critical roadmaps.

Table 1 summarises the current constellation.

Table 1: Current GEM papers and companion notes.

Domain	**Paper / Note**	**Purpose**	**Status**
Core theory	*General Emergence Mechanics: Persistence, Coherence Shells, and the Three Axes of Stable Existence*	Foundational statement of GEM	Core
Computation / AI	GEM-related AI / Frankie notes	Computational and conceptual extension of persistence ideas	Exploratory
Materials	*A Toy GEM Polymer Fatigue Simulator*	Toy simulation of fatigue, collapse, drift, and recovery	Simulation
Gravity	*Toward a Gravitational Sector of General Emergence Mechanics*	Weak-field attraction, depth gradients, horizon-like ideas	Exploratory
Gravity refinement	Refined gravitational / Einstein-like extension note	Stronger effective-action and Einstein-like structure	Exploratory
Gravity roadmap	Weaknesses / roadmap companion note	Self-critique and development priorities for gravity branch	Roadmap
Evolution	GEM persistence mechanism applied to Darwinian evolution	Persistence-based reinterpretation of adaptation and extinction	Conceptual
Biology	GEM-inspired biological coherence pod note	Body-scale persistence environment for recovery testing	Conceptual / bioengineering
Traffic	GEM-inspired traffic control framework	Persistence-based adaptive corridor control	Toy simulation / control
Constants	Emergent constants note	c, G, $\hbar$, and k_B as persistence-mechanical targets	Synthesis / roadmap

The table is intentionally broad. Some branches are mathematically stronger than others, and some remain mostly conceptual. That unevenness is a feature of an exploratory programme rather than a defect to be hidden.

5 Domain-by-Domain Summary

5.1 Core Theory

The core GEM paper establishes the framework's basic ontology and mechanics. It introduces the coherence shell, the three persistence axes, and the idea that stable existence depends on remaining above a persistence threshold.

This foundational paper is the anchor for all later developments. Its role is not to solve every domain in advance, but to provide the common language that makes cross-domain transfer possible.

5.2 Computation and AI

The computational branch explores how persistence language may apply to symbolic, algorithmic, and AI-like systems. Here GEM functions both as a conceptual lens and as a possible framework for understanding stable computational identity, drift, adaptive behaviour, and the maintenance of coherent process structure under perturbation.

This branch is philosophically important because it shows that GEM is not restricted to ordinary matter alone.

5.3 Materials and Fatigue

The materials branch is one of the clearest toy-model successes. In the polymer fatigue simulator, depth, stiffness, and viscosity generate recognisable qualitative regimes:

- brittle collapse,
- creeping distortion,
- metastability,
- clean recovery.

This matters because it shows GEM acting not merely as analogy but as a genuinely useful classification and simulation language.

5.4 Gravity

The gravitational branch is among the most ambitious. It explores whether gravity may be reinterpreted as a manifestation of persistence-depth gradients within the coherence shell. Weak-field attraction is associated with $-\nabla D$, while more advanced notes explore Einstein-like effective dynamics, time dilation as relaxation-time variation, horizon-like behaviour, and the possibility of dark-matter-like effects emerging from depth anomalies.

This branch remains exploratory, but it has now matured enough to generate both refined formulations and explicit self-critique.

5.5 Evolution

The evolutionary branch reinterprets Darwinian change as persistence exploration inside a biological shell landscape. In this view:

- mutation is exploratory perturbation,
- selection is persistence filtering,
- extinction is shell collapse,

- complexity increase is associated with deeper or richer persistence basins.

This branch is conceptually ambitious but deliberately framed as interpretive rather than as a replacement for standard evolutionary biology.

5.6 Biology and Recovery Environments

The biological branch asks whether living regulation, fatigue, recovery, and dysregulation can be described in GEM language. The most developed concept here is the biological coherence pod: a controlled body-scale persistence environment intended not as a proven therapy, but as an experimental platform for testing whether biological systems respond measurably to persistence-support conditions.

This branch is important because it shifts GEM from descriptive philosophy toward bio-engineering concepts.

5.7 Traffic and Control

The traffic branch demonstrates that GEM can act as a practical control framework. A corridor is treated as a coherence shell for vehicle flow, with congestion interpreted as loss of persistence and recovery interpreted as return to a stable flow basin.

The toy traffic simulation is especially useful because it shows GEM in operational form:

- low depth suggests demand throttling,
- low stiffness suggests speed harmonisation,
- high viscosity suggests recovery-flush actions.

This is one of the clearest examples of GEM as proactive persistence engineering.

5.8 Emergent Constants

The constants note is one of the most philosophically ambitious parts of the programme. It asks whether quantities such as c, G, $\hbar$, and k_B might be emergent shell observables rather than irreducible primitives.

The strongest current case is c, interpreted as a shell propagation speed. The others remain less mature but are organised into a single research programme. This note is valuable not because it completes those derivations, but because it makes the target structure explicit.

6 Common Themes Across the Programme

Although the GEM branches range widely, several themes recur again and again.

6.1 Persistence Under Stress

Whether one is discussing a polymer, a traffic network, a biological system, or a speculative gravitational shell, the central question is the same: how much disturbance can be absorbed without collapse?

6.2 Recovery Matters as Much as Stability

GEM does not reduce systems to static equilibrium. A system may survive immediate perturbation but still fail later because its recovery is too slow or incomplete. This is why viscosity or relaxation time is so central.

6.3 Collapse is Often Thresholded

Many branches show the same basic structure:

$$P > P_{\min} \quad \text{stable}, \qquad P < P_{\min} \quad \text{fragile or collapsing.}$$

This threshold logic is one of the strongest unifying features of GEM.

6.4 Metastability is Common

A system need not be either fully stable or fully broken. It may remain trapped in a distorted but persistent state. This is as important in materials and traffic as it is in the more speculative branches.

6.5 Control is Persistence Maintenance

The traffic branch makes this especially clear, but the logic generalises widely. Control is not simply optimisation of an output variable. It is the maintenance of coherent persistence before breakdown occurs.

7 Maturity Levels and Intellectual Discipline

One of the strengths of the current GEM programme is that it now contains not only expansion but also self-critique. Different branches should not be treated as equally established.

A reasonable maturity classification would be:

- **Most structurally developed:** core GEM, polymer toy simulation, traffic control toy simulation.
- **Exploratory but mathematically structured:** gravity, refined gravity, emergent constants.
- **Conceptual but testable:** biology pod, evolutionary reinterpretation.
- **Broader interpretive or philosophical branches:** computation / AI and future social or institutional extensions.

This unevenness should be embraced rather than concealed. A real research programme does not develop all branches at once.

8 Where MT/GCF Fits

Because readers may encounter GEM after encountering MT/GCF, it is useful to state the relationship clearly. MT/GCF functions as part of the conceptual ancestry of GEM, especially where vacuum structure, preferred phase organisation, orbifold ideas, and shell-like persistence first became important. However, GEM is now best read as a distinct framework with its own vocabulary and cross-domain programme.

In other words:

MT/GCF is part of the genealogy; GEM is the current framework.

That distinction matters for readability. A newcomer should be able to enter GEM directly, while a long-term reader can still see the continuity.

9 Next Steps for the Programme

Several natural directions now suggest themselves.

9.1 Strengthen the Simulations

The polymer and traffic branches show the value of toy models. More simulations should follow, especially where the persistence axes can be measured and manipulated directly.

9.2 Strengthen the Gravitational Derivations

The gravitational branch will need more explicit action-based derivations, more careful weak-field matching, and eventually confrontation with astrophysical data if it is to move beyond structured speculation.

9.3 Develop Experimental or Analog Platforms

The biological coherence pod is one such platform. Others may include analogue persistence environments, materials experiments, or controlled network systems.

9.4 Extend into Social and Institutional Systems

One obvious future branch is social persistence:

- trust as depth,
- decision speed and coordination as stiffness,
- post-crisis recovery time as viscosity.

This extension has not yet been formalised in a full note, but it is a natural direction for the framework.

9.5 Clarify Constant Emergence

The constants programme could become one of the most important long-term branches if even one or two constants prove to be genuinely derivable from shell structure rather than merely suggestively interpretable.

10 Conclusion

General Emergence Mechanics has now developed into a recognisable exploratory research programme. At its centre is a simple but powerful claim: stable systems persist only when they remain coherent inside a dynamical shell governed by depth, stiffness, and recovery time. From that starting point, GEM has already generated a family of connected notes spanning materials, computation, gravity, evolution, biology, traffic control, and the possible emergence of physical constants.

The value of this overview is not to pretend that every branch is equally mature. Rather, it is to show that the programme now has enough coherence to be read as a unified framework rather than as a loose scattering of speculative essays. Some branches are already operational in toy-simulation form; others remain conceptual or mathematically incomplete. But together they demonstrate the same central point: persistence may be a more general and transferable organising principle than is usually assumed.

If GEM continues to develop, its future will depend not merely on further conceptual expansion, but on deeper derivation, sharper falsifiability, and more direct confrontation with

simulation and experiment. That is the correct next challenge for the framework. But even at its current stage, GEM has already established something important: there may be a common mechanics underlying the persistence of very different kinds of systems, and that common mechanics is worth studying in its own right.

Companion Papers and DOIs

The present overview sits alongside the current GEM companion papers and related Zenodo records published so far. Together they form the present exploratory research constellation of the framework.

- P. Baldwin, *General Emergence Mechanics: Persistence, Coherence Shells, and the Three Axes of Stable Existence.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19783698`.
- P. Baldwin, *A Toy GEM Polymer Fatigue Simulator: Computational Demonstration of Emergence Mechanics.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19826401`.
- P. Baldwin, *Gravity as an Emergent Persistence Gradient: Deriving Geodesic Motion from Coherence Shell Depth in General Emergence Mechanics.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19842758`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward a Gravitational Sector of General Emergence Mechanics: Persistence Depth, Weak-Field Attraction, and Einstein-Like Effective Dynamics.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19843738`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward a Persistence-Mechanical View of Darwinian Evolution: A Speculative GEM Interpretation of Adaptation, Extinction, and Complexity.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19875903`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward a GEM-Inspired Biological Coherence Pod: A Concept Paper on Controlled Persistence Environments for Recovery and Regulation.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19878466`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward a GEM-Inspired Traffic Control Framework: Persistence Mechanics, Congestion Recovery, and Network Resilience in a Toy Corridor Simulation.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19881839`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward a Gravitational Sector of General Emergence Mechanics: Persistence Depth, Weak-Field Attraction, and Einstein-Like Effective Dynamics.* Refined version. Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19912154`.
- P. Baldwin, *Current Weaknesses and Immediate Development Priorities in the Gravitational Sector of General Emergence Mechanics.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19912673`.
- P. Baldwin, *Toward an Emergent Origin of Fundamental Constants in General Emergence Mechanics: c, G, $\hbar$, and k_B as Persistence-Mechanical Targets.* Zenodo. DOI: `https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19945071`.